MINDFIELD · BOOK REVIEW AND STRESS TEST

Ten books, checked against the evidence

Which principles from **The Gift of Fear**, **Thinking, Fast and Slow**, **The small BIG**, **Pre-Suasion**, **Influence**, **Quiet**, **The Man Who Mistook His Wife for a Hat**, **Telling Lies**, **Spy the Lie** and **Mindhunter** belong in Mindfield, what was added, and how the app held up under a full stress test, including switching between Google accounts.

53
new concepts, each labelled with how strong its evidence is

1
existing concept relabelled after checking its sources

128
automated tests, all passing on GitHub Actions

75,000
random steps across three phones and two Google accounts

THE BOOKS YOU SENT

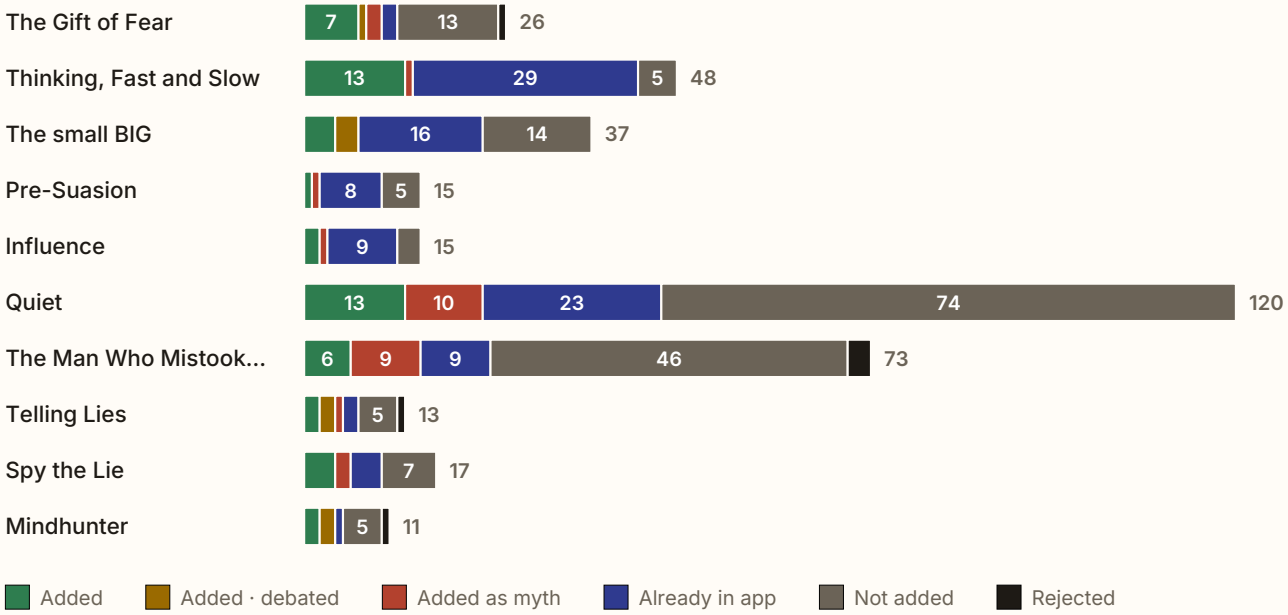
The Gift of Fear	Gavin de Becker
Thinking, Fast and Slow	Daniel Kahneman
The small BIG	Steve J. Martin, Noah J. Goldstein & Robert B. Cialdini
Pre-Suasion	Robert B. Cialdini
Influence	Robert B. Cialdini
Quiet	Susan Cain
The Man Who Mistook His Wife for a Hat	Oliver Sacks
Telling Lies	Paul Ekman
Spy the Lie	Philip Houston, Michael Floyd, Susan Carnicero & Don Tennant
Mindhunter	John E. Douglas & Mark Olshaker

SUMMARY

The short answer

Should the books' principles be in Mindfield? Some should, and now are. I reviewed 375 principles across the ten books against the strongest evidence I could find. 89 of them now map to concepts in the app, through 53 new cards: twelve teach a famous claim as a myth and six are labelled Debated. 103 were already covered. The other 183 were left out, because the evidence is weak, untested or contrary, or because they are specialist safety advice that a daily app shouldn't give without support.

Verdicts by book



Each bar counts principles; bundled rows (for example, 26 ideas already in the app from Kahneman) count once per idea. Some new cards answer principles from more than one book.

What changed in the app

- **53 new concepts**, from day 136 onward: 29 from the first five books, 15 from Quiet and The Man Who Mistook His Wife for a Hat, and 9 from Telling Lies, Spy the Lie and Mindhunter, each with its study, a real-world case, a predict-first question, a mission and sources.
- **One existing concept relabelled**: "But you are free" moved from Good to Debated (see "One existing card changed").
- **Switching Google accounts now works**, and unlinking is safe mid-sync: work already running can no longer upload your journal to the account you removed.
- **Nothing moves for existing users.** Days already seen, today's concept and review cards stay the same.

How it held up

- All **128 automated tests** pass on GitHub Actions: 86 for the core logic and content (also run locally) and 42 Android screen, reminder and widget tests.
- A **three-phone, two-account simulation** ran 75,000 random steps with no lost note, no upload to an unlinked account, and every phone ending identical to the backup.

- The stress test found **six bugs**, all fixed. Roasting my own work caught seven factual errors, a discredited source, eight missing citations and five unfair quiz scenarios in the first batch of cards and nine overstated or unconfirmed details in the second; all were fixed before release.

METHOD

How each principle was judged

Every principle went through the same four questions, in order.

1 Does it hold up?	Judged on the strongest evidence available (meta-analyses, large or registered replications, field data) rather than the single study a book cites. Retractions and misconduct findings count against a source.
2 Is it already in Mindfield?	If so, the existing card was checked instead of adding a duplicate.
3 Is it useful in daily life?	Mindfield teaches one idea a day to spot in the wild, so it has to show up in ordinary situations.
4 Is it safe to teach this way?	Crisis and personal-safety advice (stalking, domestic violence, threats) needs professional context and support, so it was left out even where research supports it.

Verdicts used in this report

Added	A new concept in the app.
Added · debated	A new concept labelled Debated: real evidence on both sides, taught with both.
Added as myth	A new concept that teaches why a famous claim is wrong.
Already in app	Covered by an existing concept.
Not added	Untested, weak, too niche, or not safe to teach in a daily app.
Rejected	Contradicted by evidence, or unfalsifiable.

Evidence labels in the app

Solid	Replicated widely, often in meta-analyses or many-lab studies.
Good	Real, but smaller, conditional or less often replicated.
Debated	Mixed replications; the card teaches both sides.
Busted	Failed to replicate or was misreported; taught as a myth.

The 53 new concepts



The whole library (204 concepts)



BOOK 1 OF 10

The Gift of Fear

Gavin de Becker · 1997, 2010 edition

A security consultant's guide to predicting violence, built on case histories. Its central advice, to take unease seriously and to notice manipulation, is reasonable. But most of its specific rules come from the author's casework rather than studies, a few are contradicted by research, and much of it is crisis advice that belongs with professionals, not in a daily app.

Added 7 · Added · debated 1 · Added as myth 2 · Already in app 2 · Not added 13 · Rejected 1

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Trust your intuition: fear warns you of danger before you can say why.	Added	Added with its limits as **When to trust your gut**. Intuition is reliable only where the world is regular and gives quick, honest feedback (Kahneman & Klein 2009). The book's cases are chosen after the fact, from hunches that proved right. Snap threat judgements can also carry bias: in video-game studies people decided to shoot armed Black targets faster than armed White ones (Correll et al. 2002).
Intuition is always right in two ways: it always responds to something, and it always has your best interest at heart.	Rejected	Unfalsifiable: any false alarm can be blamed on how we interpreted it, which is the book's own escape hatch. Confident gut feelings are often wrong where feedback is poor (Kahneman & Klein 2009).
Intuition speaks through "messengers" of rising urgency, from nagging feelings, persistent thoughts and dark humour up to suspicion, apprehension and fear.	Not added	An untested scheme. No study has checked whether these signals, or their ranking, predict danger.
Fear rule #1: the very fact that you fear something is solid evidence that it is not happening.	Not added	A reassuring rule of thumb with no evidence behind it.
Worry is not fear: real fear is a brief signal in the presence of danger; worry is a choice.	Added	Added as **Most worries never happen**: in people with generalised anxiety, about 91% of logged worries didn't come true (LaFreniere & Newman 2020). The card leaves out "worry is a choice", which is unfair to anyone with an anxiety disorder.
Denial ("it can't happen to me") is the enemy of safety.	Added	Added within **The panic myth** (normalcy bias). In the World Trade Center evacuation many people delayed: they talked to others, gathered belongings and made calls before leaving (NIST survivor interviews; Kuligowski & Mileti 2009).
Panic is usually more dangerous than the outcome we dread.	Added as myth	Contradicted. In disasters true panic is rare and people mostly help each other (Drury, Cocking & Reicher 2009, on the 2005 London bombings). Taught as **The panic myth**: delay, not panic, is the usual danger.
We fear the wrong things: strangers and rare horrors rather than everyday risks.	Already in app	Covered by **The availability heuristic**, including the roughly 1,600 extra US road deaths after people avoided flying after 9/11 (Gigerenzer 2006).

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Pre-incident indicators: forced teaming, charm and niceness, too many details, typecasting, loan sharking, the unsolicited promise and discounting "no".	Added · debated	Added as **Forced teaming and other warning signs**, labelled Debated. The tactics match well-tested compliance techniques: a trivial shared birthday raised agreement to a stranger's request from 34% to 62% (Burger et al. 2004). But the claim that they predict violence comes from casework, not studies, and hindsight makes warning signs look more obvious than they were (Winters & Jeglic 2016).
Too many details are a sign of a lie.	Added as myth	Contradicted: on average liars give fewer details, not more (DePaulo et al. 2003), and people tell lies from truths only 54% of the time (Bond & DePaulo 2006). Taught as **The myth of spotting liars**.
Someone who won't accept "no" is trying to control you; "no" is a complete sentence.	Added	Folded into the forced-teaming card and **People say yes more than you think**: refusing is harder than we expect. Asked to write "pickle" in a library book, more than 64% of strangers agreed, though requesters predicted 28% (Bohns et al. 2014).
Charm is a verb, not a trait: niceness is often a tactic.	Added	Added as **Charm that fades**: people high in narcissism are liked more than others at first and less after repeated meetings (Paulhus 1998; Back et al. 2010).
Criminals "interview" potential victims, testing boundaries before choosing one.	Not added	Some support: people judge vulnerability from how others walk, and those high in psychopathic traits do it more accurately (Grayson & Stein 1981; Book et al. 2013). In a daily app it risks implying that victims invite attacks; it belongs in a safety course.
Rule of opposites: list how a safe person behaves; the opposites are warning signs.	Not added	A handy way to draft a checklist, never tested for accuracy, and it can flag harmless traits (chatty, curious) as danger.
List three alternative predictions before settling on one.	Added	Added as **Consider the opposite**: asking how the opposite could be true reduced biased reading of evidence (Lord, Lepper & Preston 1984) and anchoring (Mussweiler et al. 2000), and weighing alternatives corrected doctors' diagnostic errors (Mamede et al. 2010).
JACA (Justification, Alternatives, Consequences, Ability) to judge a threat, and RICE (Reliability, Importance, Cost, Effectiveness) to judge a safety resource.	Not added	Plausible headings, never tested as prediction tools. Only tools validated against real outcomes reliably beat judgement (see **Simple formulas beat expert judgement**).
Rate any prediction's chances on eleven "elements of prediction".	Not added	An untested checklist from the author's firm.
People who threaten public figures are rarely the ones who attack them.	Not added	Supported by US studies of attacks on public figures (Dietz et al. 1991; Fein & Vossekuil 1999), but this is professional threat assessment, not everyday psychology.
Engage and enrage: any contact with a rejected pursuer, even an angry reply, rewards persistence; cut all contact.	Not added	Fits research on intermittent reinforcement (in the app as **Variable rewards**), but stalking advice rests on expert consensus and needs specialist support, not a daily card.

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Restraining orders can provoke violence and should be used selectively.	Not added	Partly contradicted: in Seattle, permanent protection orders were linked to about 80% less police-reported physical violence (Holt et al. 2002). Case-by-case risk is a job for specialists.
Leaving is the most dangerous time in an abusive relationship ("75 percent of spousal murders happen after the woman leaves").	Not added	Separation does raise risk (Campbell et al. 2003), though I found no solid source for the exact 75% figure. Crisis content like this needs support resources, not a daily card.
Violent media teaches children violence.	Not added	Contested: meta-analyses disagree on whether violent media has meaningful effects on real-world aggression (Anderson et al. 2010; Ferguson 2015).
Don't wear headphones when walking alone: hearing is your early warning.	Not added	Plausible safety advice, but untested and not a psychology finding.
Vet babysitters with pointed questions and checks, not a pleasant chat.	Added	Supported by **Simple formulas beat expert judgement**: across 136 studies, clinicians clearly beat simple formulas in only about 6–16% (Grove et al. 2000).
Everyone is capable of violence; seeing this "shared humanness" makes people predictable.	Already in app	Covered by **Obedience to authority** (Milgram) and **The fundamental attribution error**: situations shape behaviour more than we assume.

BOOK 2 OF 10

Thinking, Fast and Slow

Daniel Kahneman · 2011

The richest source and the best evidenced. Most of its findings on judgement and choice have held up: many were already in Mindfield and 14 more are now added. Its chapter on behavioural priming has not survived, as Kahneman acknowledged.

Added 13 · Added as myth 1 · Already in app 29 · Not added 5

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
26 ideas already in Mindfield.	Already in app	System 1 and System 2, the invisible gorilla, anchoring, availability, base-rate neglect, the Linda problem, regression to the mean, hindsight bias, the planning fallacy and outside view, overconfidence, loss aversion, the endowment effect, the negativity bias, mental accounting, framing, defaults, the peak-end rule, the focusing illusion, affective forecasting, the illusory truth effect, mere exposure, confirmation bias, the wisdom of crowds, flow, facial feedback and the marshmallow test. Each has its own card, with corrections where the evidence moved: facial feedback and the marshmallow test are labelled Debated.
Ego depletion and the hungry judges.	Already in app	Already taught as myths: ego depletion failed large multi-lab replications, and the parole pattern has simpler explanations.

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
WYSIATI: “what you see is all there is”.	Already in app	The book’s umbrella idea. It runs through existing cards (confirmation bias, the focusing illusion, base-rate neglect) rather than needing its own.
Behavioural priming: old-age words slow people’s walking; images of money make them selfish.	Added as myth	Added as **Behavioural priming**, taught as a myth: key studies failed to replicate (Doyen et al. 2012; Many Labs). Kahneman later wrote of having “placed too much faith in underpowered studies”.
The halo effect.	Added	Added (Solid): Thorndike 1920; Nisbett & Wilson 1977; competent-looking faces won about 69% of 2004 Senate races (Todorov et al. 2005).
The affect heuristic: liking something shrinks its risks and inflates its benefits.	Added	Added (Good): reading only about a technology’s benefits lowered its judged risk (Finucane et al. 2000).
The law of small numbers: small samples produce extreme results.	Added	Added (Solid): Tversky & Kahneman 1971; the small-schools mistake (Wainer & Zwerling 2006).
Outcome bias: judging decisions by how they turned out.	Added	Added (Solid): Baron & Hershey 1988; NBA coaches change their line-up more after a narrow loss than after a narrow win (Lefgren et al. 2015).
The illusions of validity and skill; when expert intuition can be trusted.	Added	Added (Good) as **When to trust your gut**: Kahneman & Klein 2009. Households that traded most earned 11.4% a year against the market’s 17.9% (Barber & Odean 2000).
Simple formulas beat intuitive expert judgement (Meehl).	Added	Added (Solid): across 136 studies clinicians were clearly better in only about 6–16% (Grove et al. 2000); an algorithm could have cut jailing by 41.9% with no rise in crime (Kleinberg et al. 2018).
The premortem.	Added	Added (Good): imagining an outcome had already happened raised the reasons people found by about 30% (Mitchell et al. 1989); Veinott et al. 2010.
Goals act as reference points.	Added	Added (Solid) as **Round numbers as goals**: nearly four times as many batters finish a season on .300 as on .299 (Pope & Simonsohn 2011), and marathon finishes bunch just before round times (Allen et al. 2017).
The fourfold pattern: the certainty and possibility effects.	Added	Added (Solid): Kahneman & Tversky 1979; 94% of the original items replicated in 19 countries (Ruggeri et al. 2020).
Denominator neglect: a 7-in-100 chance can feel better than 1 in 10.	Added	Added (Solid): Denes-Raj & Epstein 1994; Yamagishi 1997.
Narrow framing: think like a trader and judge risks as a bundle.	Added	Added (Good): Gneezy & Potters 1997; Benartzi & Thaler 1999; seen in professional traders too (Haigh & List 2005), though not in every task.
Joint versus separate evaluation: less can look better.	Added	Added (Good) as **Less is better**: Hsee 1998; List 2002; mostly confirmed by a close replication (Vonasch et al. 2023).

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Above about $75,000 a year, money stops improving day-to-day happiness.	Added	Added as **Money and happiness, revised**: an adversarial collaboration found well-being keeps rising with income for most people and levels off only for the unhappiest (Killingsworth, Kahneman & Mellers 2023).
Cognitive strain: a hard-to-read font makes people reason more carefully.	Not added	Failed: pooling the original study with 16 replication attempts (about 7,400 people) found no benefit (Meyer et al. 2015).
The mood heuristic: asking students about dates first changes how happy they say they are.	Not added	Later work found such question-order effects are usually small (Schimmack & Oishi 2005).
Regret is stronger after actions than after inaction.	Not added	Mixed: over the long run people regret inaction more (Gilovich & Medvec 1995), and after a bad prior outcome the pattern flips (Zeelenberg et al. 2002).
Fairness norms limit what firms can charge (dual entitlement).	Not added	Good evidence (Kahneman, Knetsch & Thaler 1986); a candidate for a future update.
The disposition effect: investors sell winners too early and hold losers too long.	Not added	Solid (Odean 1998), but it overlaps the loss aversion card; a candidate for a future update.

BOOK 3 OF 10

The small BIG

Steve J. Martin, Noah J. Goldstein & Robert B. Cialdini · 2014

Fifty-two short chapters, each built on one or two studies. Many repeat ideas already in Mindfield. Seven are good additions (three labelled Debated); many rest on single small studies or narrow business settings; and a few lean on researchers whose other work has been retracted.

Added 4 · Added · debated 3 · Already in app 16 · Not added 14

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
16 ideas already in Mindfield.	Already in app	Telling people most others pay their tax on time (Social proof); warning that a bad behaviour is common, which backfires (When social proof backfires); defaults; if-then plans; commitment devices; Save More Tomorrow (Present bias); first offers as anchors; .99 price endings (Left-digit bias); the identifiable victim; a head start on loyalty cards (The endowed progress effect); the goal gradient; uniforms and credentials (Authority); the sunk cost fallacy; framing; gifts that trigger reciprocity; and stepping back to see a problem as an outsider (Self-distancing).
Disorder spreads: graffiti and litter invite more rule-breaking (broken windows).	Added · debated	Added as **Broken windows**, labelled Debated: strong field experiments (Keizer et al. 2008), but aggressive order-maintenance policing showed no significant crime reduction (Braga et al. 2015), and a meta-analysis found no consistent link from disorder to residents' aggression (O'Brien et al. 2019).

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
People favour jobs, places and causes that resemble their own names.	Added · debated	Added as **Implicit egotism**, labelled Debated: early findings (Pelham et al. 2002) shrank or vanished once age and other confounds were controlled (Simonsohn 2011).
Moral licensing: a good deed licenses a bad one.	Added · debated	Added as **Moral licensing**, labelled Debated: a 2015 meta-analysis found a small-to-moderate effect, but correcting for publication bias shrinks it to between nothing and small (Kuper & Bott 2019).
Meetings dwell on what everyone already knows and miss what only one person knows.	Added	Added as **Hidden profiles** (Solid): with the facts split, as few as 12% of groups found the best candidate, against 83% when everyone had every fact (Stasser & Titus 1985); confirmed by a meta-analysis of 65 studies (Lu et al. 2012).
If you need help, just ask: people say yes more than you expect.	Added	Added as **People say yes more than you think** (Good): to get five people to fill in a questionnaire, requesters expected to ask about 20 and needed about 10 (Flynn & Lake 2008; Bohns 2016).
Adding a weaker item dilutes a strong offer (the presenter's paradox).	Added	Added within **Less is better** (Good): Weaver, Garcia & Schwarz 2012; Hsee 1998.
Remind people that money spent here can't be spent elsewhere.	Added	Added as **Opportunity cost neglect** (Good): purchases of a DVD fell from 75% to 55% (Frederick et al. 2009); a meta-analysis of 39 experiments found a real but much smaller effect (Maguire, Persson & Tinghög 2023).
Error management training: let trainees make mistakes.	Not added	Good evidence (a meta-analysis of 24 studies: Keith & Frese 2008), but it's about designing training rather than everyday life; a candidate for later.
9 tips that rest on one or two studies each.	Not added	Future-self images, the preference for potential, empowering an uncertain expert, the venue of a negotiation, feeling powerful before a pitch, unit asking, the timing of review requests, a small change to negotiation emails, and touching a product. The studies are often small or in narrow sales settings; worth revisiting if large replications appear.
Romance and "love" cues raise tips and helping (Nicolas Guéguen's studies).	Not added	Not added: the data behind these studies were publicly questioned, and several of Guéguen's papers have since been retracted (Retraction Watch 2025). The same concern led to relabelling the existing card **"But you are free"** (see "One existing card changed").
Gift registries, gratitude, and "meaningless" reward categories (studies co-authored by Francesca Gino).	Not added	Not added on this evidence: four of Gino's other papers were retracted in 2023 after a Harvard misconduct finding, which Gino disputes. The better-replicated gratitude finding is already in the app (**Undervaluing gratitude**).

BOOK 4 OF 10

Pre-Suasion

Robert B. Cialdini · 2016

Its big idea, that what people are focused on just before a message changes how they receive it, is partly right: anchoring, framing and "what's focal seems causal" are well supported. But many of its examples rest on subtle priming, the kind of evidence that has worn badly.

Added 1 | Added as myth 1 | Already in app 8 | Not added 5

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Privileged moments: what you put in front of people first shapes how they react to what follows.	Already in app	The robust forms are in the app (Anchoring, The framing effect, The contrast principle). Many of the book's examples use subtle incidental cues (French music selling French wine; fluffy clouds on a furniture website), the kind of priming that has replicated poorly.
What's focal seems causal.	Added	Added as **What's focal seems causal** (Good): observers credit whoever they can see best (Taylor & Fiske 1975), and confessions filmed facing the suspect look more voluntary, even to judges (Lassiter et al. 2007).
Whatever draws our attention seems important.	Already in app	Covered by **The focusing illusion**.
Attractors: sex, threat and the unusual grab attention, and sex sells when the product is bought for sexual reasons.	Not added	Grabbing attention isn't persuading: a meta-analysis of 53 experiments (8,489 people) found sexual and violent content didn't make ads work better and often made brands less memorable and less liked (Lull & Bushman 2015).
Magnetizers: what's self-relevant holds attention.	Already in app	Covered by **The self-reference effect**.
Magnetizers: unfinished tasks stay on our minds (the Zeigarnik effect).	Already in app	Already taught as a myth: the memory advantage for unfinished tasks doesn't reliably replicate.
Magnetizers: open with a mystery.	Not added	Sensible teaching advice with little experimental evidence.
Associations: a word or image (achievement, money, old age) shifts behaviour without our noticing.	Added as myth	Taught as a myth in **Behavioural priming**: flagship studies failed to replicate.
Persuasive geographies: women do better on maths and leadership tasks in rooms with photos of women who excelled at them.	Not added	Rests on a few small studies; the related claim that stereotype reminders lower girls' maths scores failed a registered test with 2,064 Dutch students (Flore, Mulder & Wicherts 2018).
Unity through being together: kinship, place and shared names (96% returned a survey when the requester shared their surname).	Already in app	The shared-identity core is in the app (**Similarity attracts**, **The minimal group effect**). The 96% figure comes from one of Guéguen's studies and wasn't used.

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Unity through acting together: moving in synchrony makes people kinder to each other.	Not added	Uncertain: counting only experiments whose experimenters didn't know the condition, the effect is indistinguishable from zero (Atwood, Schachner & Mehr 2022, reanalysing Rennung & Göritz 2016); others dispute that reading.
If-then plans (people in drug withdrawal who planned when and where to write a CV).	Already in app	Covered by **If-then plans**.
The six principles: reciprocity, liking, social proof, authority, scarcity and consistency.	Already in app	Each has its own card (see Influence).
Ethical influence pays; deceptive tactics cost trust in the long run.	Not added	An argument rather than a testable claim.
Post-suasion: make change last with commitments and habits.	Already in app	Covered by **Commitment devices**, **Foot in the door** and the habit cards.

BOOK 5 OF 10

Influence

Robert B. Cialdini · 2007 edition

The classic. Its six principles were already well represented in Mindfield. Three of its examples are now taught differently: physical attractiveness within the halo effect, basking in reflected glory as a card of its own, and the Romeo and Juliet effect as a myth.

Added 2 · Added as myth 1 · Already in app 9 · Not added 3

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Click, whirr: a reason, even an empty one ("because I have to make copies"), wins compliance.	Already in app	**The power of "because"** (Langer, Blank & Chanowitz 1978), with its limits.
Reciprocity: a small unasked-for favour (Regan's Coke) earns a bigger one back.	Already in app	**Reciprocity**.
Reciprocal concessions: start big, then retreat.	Already in app	**Door in the face**.
Commitment and consistency: small first steps, low-balling, written commitments.	Already in app	**Foot in the door**, **The low-ball technique**, **Commitment devices**.
Social proof, including bystanders who don't help.	Already in app	**Social proof** and **The bystander effect (and its twist)**, with the corrected Kitty Genovese story.
Liking: similarity, compliments, contact and cooperation.	Already in app	**Similarity attracts**, **Compliments matter more than you think**, **The contact hypothesis**.

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Physical attractiveness makes people seem more talented, kind and honest.	Added	Added within **The halo effect** (Solid).
Basking in reflected glory: “we won”, but “they lost”.	Added	Added as **Basking in reflected glory** (Good): Cialdini et al. 1976; Flemish voters kept a winning party’s posters up longer than a losing one’s (Boen et al. 2002).
Authority: obedience (Milgram), and nurses following a phoned-in order (Hofling).	Already in app	**Obedience to authority** and **Authority**, including the follow-up where nurses rarely complied when they knew the drug and could consult colleagues (Rank & Jacobson 1977).
Scarcity: cookies from a near-empty jar taste better; bans make things more desirable.	Already in app	**Scarcity** (Worchel et al. 1975) and **Reactance**.
The contrast principle.	Already in app	**The contrast principle**.
The Romeo and Juliet effect: parents’ opposition deepens love.	Added as myth	Taught as a myth: a registered replication found more interference went with less love, commitment and trust (Sinclair, Hood & Wright 2014).
The Werther effect: publicised suicides are followed by more suicides, and even car and plane crashes.	Not added	Suicide contagion is real and media guidelines exist, but the crash findings are 1970s correlations, and the topic is too sensitive for a casual daily card.
Shooting the messenger: we dislike people who bring bad news.	Not added	Good evidence (John, Blunden & Liu 2019); a candidate for a future update.
Rising expectations dashed by a setback spark revolts (Davies’ J-curve).	Not added	Historical theory, outside the app’s scope.

BOOK 6 OF 10

Quiet

Susan Cain · 2012

A persuasive case for introverts that mixes real research with advocacy. Its best-supported points hold up: talkers win influence whatever their ideas, people brainstorm better alone, and open offices and constant switching cost focus. Several of its scientific claims have not aged well, among them the serotonin-gene story, the 10,000-hour rule and the idea that people come in two types. Its parenting and self-help advice is sensible but mostly untested.

Added 13 · Added as myth 10 · Already in app 23 · Not added 74

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Talkative, fast, assertive people are judged smarter and more competent, and whoever talks most becomes the leader.	Added	Added as **The babble effect** (Good): dominant students spoke up first and were rated more competent, though their maths scores and answers were no better (Anderson & Kilduff 2009); speaking time predicted who emerged as leader even after intelligence and personality were taken into account (MacLaren et al. 2020).
Charisma doesn't make leaders effective; many of the best leaders are quiet.	Not added	Partly right. In 128 large US companies, executives' ratings of their CEO's charisma followed past results but didn't predict future ones (Agle et al. 2006). But across 73 samples extraversion was the Big Five trait most consistently linked to leadership (r = .31; Judge et al. 2002). Too mixed for a card of its own; The babble effect carries the useful part.
Introverted leaders get better results from proactive teams.	Not added	One paper, a pizza-chain field study plus a lab study (Grant, Gino & Hofmann 2011), not yet widely replicated.
"Level 5" leaders are humble and quiet (Good to Great).	Already in app	Choosing great companies after the fact and listing what they share is the trap in **Survivorship bias**.
Introverts can act out of character for projects they care about (Free Trait Theory), but need "restorative niches".	Added	Added as **Acting extraverted** (Good): acting extraverted lifts mood even for introverts, who underestimate how good it will feel (Zelenski et al. 2013); in a week-long trial the most introverted got little benefit and felt more tired and less authentic (Jacques-Hamilton, Sun & Smillie 2019).
People are introverts or extroverts, and a third to a half of people are introverts.	Added as myth	Added as **The personality type myth**: extraversion is a continuous trait on which most people score near the middle (Bess & Harvey 2002), so the share of "introverts" depends on where the line is drawn; in one study about half of people got a different type when retested five weeks later (Pittenger 2005).
Introversion is 40 to 50 percent heritable, and heritability describes groups, not individuals.	Added	True, and taught in the nuance of **The single-gene myth**: twin studies put the average heritability of human traits at 49% (Polderman et al. 2015), spread across thousands of genes with tiny effects.

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
A serotonin-transporter gene (5-HTTLPR) makes people sensitive, introverted and prone to depression under stress; other gene variants predict financial risk-taking.	Added as myth	Added as **The single-gene myth**: the famous gene-by-stress finding (Caspi et al. 2003) found no support in 38,802 people (Culverhouse et al. 2018), and 18 candidate genes for depression did no better than random genes in samples of up to about 443,000 (Border et al. 2019).
Group brainstorming produces fewer and worse ideas than people working alone; generate ideas alone, then share.	Already in app	**The brainstorming myth** (Solid), including the advice to collect ideas alone and pool them afterwards.
Open-plan offices reduce productivity and harm health.	Added	Added as **Open-plan offices** (Good): face-to-face interaction fell by about 70% when two companies moved to open plan (Bernstein & Turban 2018), and Danish employees in open offices of more than six people had 62% more sick days (Pejtersen et al. 2011). Most of the evidence is observational, and the card says so.
Multitasking is a myth: switching between tasks costs time and raises errors "by up to 50 percent".	Added	Added as **The multitasking myth** (Solid), on the task-switching research (Rubinstein, Meyer & Evans 2001) and the driving-simulator studies (Strayer & Johnston 2001). The book's 50% figure comes from a popular-science book and wasn't used.
Expertise takes about 10,000 hours of deliberate practice, best done alone.	Added as myth	Added as **The 10,000-hour rule**, taught as a myth: practice matters, but it explained 21% of the differences in skill in music and 18% in sports (Macnamara et al. 2014), and when the violin study was repeated the best players hadn't practised more than the good ones (Macnamara & Maitra 2019).
Being watched makes people perform worse.	Added	Added as **Social facilitation** (Good): an audience helps with well-practised tasks and hurts with new or complex ones, though the effects are small (Bond & Titus 1983, 241 studies). The book's examples, such as a basketball team playing without spectators, are single cases.
Venting anger feeds it rather than releasing it.	Added as myth	Added as **The venting myth**, and the book gets this one right: hitting a punching bag while thinking of the provoker increased anger and aggression (Bushman 2002), and across 154 studies calming activities reduced anger while revving up didn't (Kjærvik & Bushman 2024).
People conform to groups without noticing, and a brain-scan study suggests conforming changes perception itself.	Already in app	**Conformity** (Asch) is in the app. The claim that conforming alters perception rests on one brain-scan study and a contested reading of brain activity, so it wasn't added.
High-reactive babies (Kagan) tend to grow into cautious, introverted adults; temperament is a rubber band that stretches only so far.	Not added	Kagan's long-term studies are respected, but they show a loose tendency rather than a fate, as the book itself says. A one-idea card would turn a tendency into a label.
Highly sensitive people (sensory-processing sensitivity) process more deeply, feel more and make up 15 to 20 percent of people.	Not added	Still debated: how far the questionnaire measures something distinct from neuroticism is argued, and that share depends on where the cut-off is drawn.

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
"Orchid" children suffer more in harsh homes but thrive more in good ones (differential susceptibility).	Not added	An active research area with mixed results, and the gene markers it leaned on failed to replicate (see The single-gene myth).
Introverts and extroverts differ in reward sensitivity, dopamine "buzz", risk-taking, persistence and caution.	Not added	Real but small average differences, mostly from small lab studies; the overlap is too large to tell an individual anything.
Creative achievers tend to be introverts; solitude feeds creativity.	Not added	Partly supported: a meta-analysis found creative people somewhat more introverted, and much more open to experience (Feist 1998). Correlational, and nothing to practise.
Opposites attract: introverts and extroverts pair up and complement each other.	Already in app	**Similarity attracts**: attraction follows similarity more than difference.
Suppressed emotions leak out; emotional labour and constant self-monitoring have costs.	Already in app	**Reappraisal**: hiding an emotion keeps it running inside, while reinterpreting the situation changes it.
Botox users feel less anger; a confident posture changes how you feel.	Already in app	**The facial feedback hypothesis** (Debated) and **Power posing** (taught as a myth).
A few close relationships matter more than many acquaintances.	Already in app	**Connection and health**, with **The strength of weak ties** as the counterpoint: acquaintances often bring new jobs and information.
Your nerves don't show when you speak in public.	Already in app	**The illusion of transparency**.
Personality is stable in rank but matures with age; behaviour depends on the situation.	Already in app	**The end-of-history illusion** and **The fundamental attribution error**.
The "Extrovert Ideal": a culture of personality replaced a culture of character, and schools and offices were built for extroverts.	Not added	History and cultural argument rather than testable principles.
Cultures differ in how they value shyness and silence (for example, China and North America).	Not added	Interesting comparisons, some already overtaken by social change, as the book notes; not principles to practise.
Parenting and teaching quiet children: gradual exposure, no labels, small groups, deep interests.	Not added	Sensible advice, but mostly untested as stated and better suited to parenting guides than to a one-idea-a-day app.
Self-help for introverts: restorative niches, "Free Trait Agreements", a social quota, soft power, quiet negotiation.	Not added	Practical suggestions without tests of their own; the tested core is in Acting extraverted.
Empathy among college students fell between 1979 and 2009.	Not added	A trend in self-report surveys, not a principle to practise.

BOOK 7 OF 10

The Man Who Mistook His Wife for a Hat

Oliver Sacks · 1985

Oliver Sacks's case histories made neurology vivid, but they are stories about single patients, not tests, and in December 2025 The New Yorker reported, from Sacks's own journals, that some details in them were changed or invented. So no verdict here rests on the cases. Where the book makes general claims about the mind, they were checked against independent research: two became cards, several are now known to be wrong and are taught as myths, and most of the rest are clinical observations that don't belong in a daily psychology app.

Added 6 | Added as myth 9 | Already in app 9 | Not added 46 | Rejected 3

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
A person can see clearly yet fail to recognise faces, and get by on voices, hair or walk instead (Dr P.).	Added	Added as **Face blindness** (Good): 17 of 689 German students (2.5%) had lifelong face blindness (Kennerknecht et al. 2006), though estimates run from about 0.1% to 5.4% depending on the cut-off (DeGutis et al. 2023). Dr P.'s condition was a rarer kind, caused by brain disease.
Moods outlast the memories that caused them; feeling, not memory, keeps a person reachable (Jimmie G.).	Added	Added as **Feelings outlast memories** (Good): people with amnesia stayed sad after forgetting sad film clips (Feinstein, Duff & Tranel 2010), and so did people with early Alzheimer's disease (Guzmán-Vélez, Feinstein & Tranel 2014).
Familiar people and preferences survive amnesia.	Added	Part of **Feelings outlast memories**: people with Korsakoff's amnesia came to prefer a "good guy" whose biography they couldn't recall (Johnson, Kim & Risse 1985).
The left hemisphere works like a computer; the right grasps reality and the self.	Added as myth	An old simplification. Its popular offspring is taught as a myth in **Left-brained and right-brained people**: scans of 1,011 people found networks that lean to one side, but no such types (Nielsen et al. 2013).
Adult humans have a feeble sense of smell compared with dogs and children.	Added as myth	Added as **The weak human nose myth**: the belief traces to Paul Broca's 19th-century anatomy, not to tests (McGann 2017), and blindfolded students followed a chocolate scent trail across a field (Porter et al. 2007).
The brain keeps an almost perfect record of experience, which seizures and brain stimulation can replay (Penfield).	Added as myth	Added as **The video-camera memory myth**: only 40 of Penfield's 1,100-plus patients reported such experiences, and they looked more like reconstructions than recordings (Loftus & Loftus 1980).
Hypnosis and "truth drugs" can bring back repressed memories.	Added as myth	Part of **The video-camera memory myth**: hypnosis produced more than twice as many new "memories", most of them wrong and held with confidence (Dywan & Bowers 1983).

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Grief is a slow "work" that passes through stages.	Added as myth	Added as **The five stages of grief**: resilience was the most common pattern among 205 older adults followed from before their spouse died (Bonanno et al. 2002), and acceptance was the most common feeling from the first month in another study (Maciejewski et al. 2007).
When memory or perception fails, the brain invents plausible stories without knowing it (confabulation).	Already in app	**Choice blindness** shows the everyday version: people readily explain choices they never made.
Once you know a condition, you start seeing it everywhere.	Already in app	**The frequency illusion**.
Invisible disabilities get read as character flaws.	Already in app	**The fundamental attribution error**.
People adapt to catastrophic loss: function returns, some feelings don't.	Already in app	**Hedonic adaptation** and **The impact bias**.
Overprotection holds people back; purpose and a role hold them together.	Already in app	**Learned helplessness (revised)**, **Self-efficacy** and **Self-determination theory**.
Speech is more than words: tone and gesture carry much of the meaning.	Already in app	**The 7-38-55 myth** shows where the popular version goes too far.
People with aphasia read tone and expression so well that "you can't lie to an aphasic".	Not added	One small study found 10 people with aphasia better than controls at spotting concealed emotion (61% against about 46%; Etcoff et al. 2000), but it hasn't been built on, and lie detection in general sits near chance (see **The myth of spotting liars**).
Tourette's is the "cursing disease", and far commoner than once thought.	Not added	Half right: it is far commoner than the one-in-a-million figure once quoted, but involuntary swearing affects a minority: at some point in life, 19% of males and 15% of females in a large clinical sample (Freeman et al. 2009). Medical, so left out.
Proprioception is a hidden sixth sense; without it the body feels unreal.	Not added	Accurate neurology with no everyday practice attached.
Phantom limbs are common, and phantom pain is real pain.	Not added	True and well documented, but clinical.
Musical hallucinations, seizures that replay memories, and smells that trigger vivid nostalgia.	Not added	Real but mostly rare clinical phenomena; the everyday version, smells cueing old memories, is a candidate for a future update.
Savants: islands of extraordinary skill in memory, calendars, music or drawing.	Not added	Real and documented, but rare, and nothing to spot or practise in daily life.
The twins who traded six-digit primes and "saw" numbers without calculating.	Rejected	Unconfirmed: Sacks's table of primes couldn't check the longest numbers, a 2007 review judged the account doubtful (Yamaguchi 2007), and the 2025 report on Sacks's journals undermines the case histories as evidence.

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Tests that look only for deficits miss people's strengths; ability depends on the setting.	Not added	A fair caution, but it rests on single case histories rather than a finding that can be taught.
Music and rhythm organise movement and can reach people with dementia.	Not added	Supported in clinical research, such as rhythmic cues helping people with Parkinson's walk, but it is therapy rather than everyday psychology.
We are our stories: identity as an inner narrative.	Not added	An influential idea in personality psychology, but the evidence is mostly correlational; a candidate for a future update.
Brain disease and drugs can feel like wellness or creativity; vitamin B6 megadoses can damage nerves.	Not added	Medical observations outside the app's scope.
Hildegard of Bingen's visions were migraine auras.	Not added	Retrospective diagnosis that can't be tested.
Case-history "romantic science" should complement mechanistic neurology.	Not added	A view of how to do science rather than a testable claim. The 2025 report shows its risk: a story can be shaped to fit its point.

BOOK 8 OF 10

Telling Lies

Paul Ekman · 1985, 2009 edition

A psychologist's account of why lies fail and the clues that betray them, from the face, voice and body. Its warnings have aged well: lie catchers are overconfident, nervous innocents look guilty, and no single sign means lying. Its promises have aged less well: the specific facial and vocal clues are rare and weak in later research, and microexpression training doesn't improve accuracy.

Added 2 · Added · debated 2 · Added as myth 1 · Already in app 2 · Not added 5 · Rejected 1

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Most people, professionals included, are poor at telling lies from truths, and confidence doesn't track accuracy.	Already in app	**The myth of spotting liars**: 54% accuracy across 206 studies (Bond & DePaulo 2006).
The Othello error: truthful people who fear being disbelieved show the same emotions as liars.	Added	Added as **The presumption of guilt**: interrogators who expected guilt pressed innocent suspects hardest, and listeners then rated those suspects more defensive (Kassin, Goldstein & Savitsky 2003).
Microexpressions, flashes of concealed emotion lasting a fraction of a second, reveal lies.	Added as myth	Taught as **The microexpression myth**: they appeared in 2% of 697 expressions, never as full-face flashes (Porter & ten Brinke 2008), and training to spot them didn't help (Jordan et al. 2019).

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
The Brokaw hazard: what's a clue for one person is a habit for another, so judge change from a person's usual behaviour.	Not added	A fair caution against over-reading habits, but not a technique with tested accuracy; Spy the Lie rejects baselining as easy to game.
Felt smiles involve the muscle around the eyes; false and masking smiles don't.	Not added	Real differences on average, but posed and spontaneous smiles contained similar shares of Duchenne smiles (Krumhuber & Manstead 2009), so the eye muscle isn't a reliable sign of sincerity.
Detection apprehension, deception guilt and duping delight make lies leak.	Not added	A plausible account with little direct testing; cues to lying are weak overall (DePaulo et al. 2003).
Voice pitch rises, pauses and speech errors increase, and illustrator gestures drop when people lie.	Not added	Small, inconsistent effects in the meta-analysis of 158 cues (DePaulo et al. 2003).
The polygraph detects arousal, not lies; innocent people can fail and the guilty can pass.	Added · debated	Added as **The lie detector test**, labelled Debated (National Research Council 2003).
The guilty knowledge test is safer than asking "did you do it?"	Added · debated	Part of **The lie detector test**: the concealed information test has the stronger scientific basis.
Victims often collude in being fooled, as Chamberlain did with Hitler.	Added	Part of **The truth default**: we believe unless something triggers doubt (Levine 2014); most lies are found later from evidence (Park et al. 2002).
A few people, such as some Secret Service agents, are highly accurate lie catchers.	Rejected	The number of "wizards" is about what chance would produce among many people tested (Bond & Uysal 2007), and differences in judging ability are small (Bond & DePaulo 2008).
Some people are consistently good or bad liars.	Not added	Supported: senders differ far more in how believable they look than judges differ in skill (Bond & DePaulo 2008). A candidate for a future update.
Self-deception, as in the Challenger launch decision, blurs the line between lying and error.	Already in app	**Groupthink** covers the Challenger decision.

BOOK 9 OF 10

Spy the Lie

Philip Houston, Michael Floyd, Susan Carnicero & Don Tennant · 2012

Former CIA interviewers teach their model: ask a question, watch the first five seconds, and act only on clusters of two or more verbal or nonverbal “indicators”. The book’s cautions match the research: it dismisses eye contact, microexpressions, nervousness and baselining, and says no one is a human lie detector. But its own model has never been tested in a published study, and its confession tactics carry a cost the book doesn’t mention.

Added 4 · Added as myth 2 · Already in app 4 · Not added 7

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
There is no such thing as a human or mechanical lie detector.	Already in app	Agrees with **The myth of spotting liars** and **The lie detector test**.
People lie at least ten times a day.	Added as myth	Contradicted. Taught in **A few prolific liars**: the average was 1.65 lies a day, 60% told none, and half of all lies came from about 5% of people (Serota, Levine & Boster 2010).
The truth bias: we want to believe people, which is the biggest obstacle to catching lies.	Added	Added as **The truth default**. Levine’s research agrees that we believe by default, but finds it is usually rational, because most statements are true.
Eye contact, closed posture, nervousness, blushing and clenched hands are unreliable.	Already in app	**The myth of spotting liars** (DePaulo et al. 2003; Bond & DePaulo 2006).
Microexpressions show emotion, not lies, and are impractical in real time.	Added as myth	Agrees with the research; part of **The microexpression myth**.
Don’t baseline: people differ, and the deceptive can game control questions.	Not added	A reasonable caution, untested as stated, and not a principle to teach on its own.
The model: look for a cluster of two or more indicators within five seconds of a question.	Not added	Never tested in a published study. The rule limits reading too much into single behaviours, but its accuracy is unknown.
Verbal indicators: no explicit denial, repeating the question, qualifiers (“basically”), “convincing statements”, invoking religion, selective memory, attack mode.	Not added	Untested as a set. Similar word-based systems, such as Scientific Content Analysis (SCAN), failed to tell true from fabricated accounts when tested (Bogaard et al. 2016).
Nonverbal indicators: pauses, hiding the mouth or eyes, throat clearing, grooming, anchor-point movements.	Not added	Small or no links to lying in the meta-analysis of 158 cues (DePaulo et al. 2003).
Truthful-sounding behaviour can be faked, so ignore it.	Not added	An interesting asymmetry, but untested, and it risks confirming suspicion (see **The presumption of guilt**).

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Our biases decide whom we believe; a calm teenage girl was wrongly disbelieved because she didn't seem upset.	Added	Added as **The emotional victim effect**: credibility tracked the emotions a witness showed, not the content of the story (Kaufmann et al. 2003).
Elicit with open questions and stay non-confrontational; repeated denials entrench a liar.	Added	Part of **The presumption of guilt** and **False confessions**: information-gathering interviews produce more true and fewer false confessions than accusatory ones (Meissner et al. 2014).
Question prologues with rationalisation, minimisation and projection of blame encourage confessions.	Added	Taught with its cost in **False confessions**: minimisation raised false confessions as well as true ones and made a confession worth less as evidence (Russano et al. 2005).
Bait questions ("Is there any reason someone would say they saw you?") and presumptive questions.	Not added	Hinting at evidence that may not exist is close to the false-evidence ploy, which raises false confessions in experiments (Kassin & Kiechel 1996).
People comply with a request when given a reason, even a meaningless one.	Already in app	**The power of "because"**.
Most communication is nonverbal.	Already in app	Taught as **The 7-38-55 myth**.

BOOK 10 OF 10

Mindhunter

John E. Douglas & Mark Olshaker · 1995, 2016 edition

A memoir of the FBI agent who helped build criminal profiling, told through cases. It is gripping and often humane, but it is the profilers' own account of their hits. When profiling has been tested, profilers barely beat comparison groups, the FBI's organized/disorganized types don't appear in data, and a confident profile helped send the Rachel Nickell investigation after the wrong man.

Added 2 · Added · debated 2 · Already in app 1 · Not added 5 · Rejected 1

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Profiling can infer an unknown offender's age, job, background and personality from the crime scene.	Added · debated	Added as **Criminal profiling**, labelled Debated: profilers were no better than comparison groups on most characteristics and only marginally better overall (Snook et al. 2007).
Offenders are "organized" or "disorganized", and each type has a matching background.	Added · debated	Part of **Criminal profiling**: across 100 US serial murders the two types didn't appear; "organized" features were present in most crimes (Canter et al. 2004).
Bedwetting, fire-setting and cruelty to animals (the "homicidal triad") mark future killers.	Rejected	Not supported as a predictor: the three rarely occur together in violent offenders, and each is better read as a sign of a troubled childhood (Parfitt & Alleyne 2020).

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	EVIDENCE AND REASONING
Modus operandi changes as offenders learn; the "signature" stays the same.	Not added	Research on linking crimes finds offenders fairly consistent and distinctive in some behaviours, but the signature idea itself is untested, and it is specialist police work.
A profile is a guide that narrows the search, not a way to convict.	Added	Part of **Criminal profiling**: police rated the same vague profile accurate whether the offender was real or fabricated (Alison et al. 2003), which is how a profile can make a wrong suspect look right, as in the Colin Stagg case.
Studying offenders by interviewing them in prison reveals how they think.	Not added	Offenders' self-reports are a weak base, and the FBI's interview study used no comparison group.
Interrogation themes that offer the suspect a face-saving story produce confessions.	Added	Taught with its cost in **False confessions** (Russano et al. 2005; Meissner et al. 2014).
Some killers inject themselves into the investigation or return to the scene.	Not added	Case lore; there is no systematic evidence of how often it happens.
Victimology: understanding the victim's risk helps understand the crime.	Not added	Reasonable investigative practice, but outside an everyday-psychology app.
Offender fantasy escalates through rehearsal to violence.	Not added	Built on interviews with a small set of offenders, without comparison groups.
A confident expert can be wrong; investigators should test hypotheses.	Already in app	**Overconfidence** and **Confirmation bias**.

ALSO CHECKED

One existing card changed

Two of the books cite studies by Nicolas Guéguen. Checking that work led back to a concept already in Mindfield.

“But you are free”

Was: Good Now: Debated

The claim: adding “but you are free to refuse” to a request makes people more likely to agree. In the original study, from 10% to 47.5% of strangers gave money for a bus fare (Guéguen & Pascual 2000), and a 2013 meta-analysis of 42 studies found a reliable effect (Carpenter 2013).

What changed: a 2023 re-examination, co-written by Alexandre Pascual, who ran the original study, pooled 74 results. The average looked sizeable, but most studies were small, there were strong signs that unsuccessful ones went unpublished, and some had been publicly questioned for possible data problems. The seven studies at low risk of bias showed no clear effect (Fillon et al. 2023). Several of Guéguen’s papers have since been retracted.

The card now says so, and keeps the practical advice: telling people they’re free to refuse is respectful and costs nothing, but don’t count on it to raise your yes rate.

A card I wrote, corrected before release

My first draft of **Consider the opposite** built its real-world case on a 2002 study by Lawrence Sanna, who resigned in 2012 amid questions about data in other studies; several papers were later retracted. That study isn’t retracted, but its effects are unusually large for its field. The case now uses a JAMA study instead: second-year residents misdiagnosed look-alike cases after seeing similar ones (accuracy 1.55 out of 4, against 2.19 on other cases), and weighing the evidence for and against each possible diagnosis lifted it to 2.03 (Mamede et al. 2010).

WHAT WAS ADDED

The 53 new concepts

New concepts sit at the end of each area, so they arrive from day 136 onward. The day shown is when someone who started on day 1 meets each one.

From the first five books (29)

DAY	CONCEPT	AREA	EVIDENCE	KEY STUDIES
136	What's focal seems causal	Perception	Good	Taylor & Fiske 1975; camera angle changes how voluntary a confession looks (Lassiter et al. 2007)
146	Implicit egotism (Dennis the dentist)	Self	Debated	Pelham et al. 2002, largely explained by confounds (Simonsohn 2011)
148	Behavioural priming (the Florida effect) (Social priming)	Influence	Busted	Bargh et al. 1996 failed to replicate (Doyen et al. 2012; Many Labs)
151	Simple formulas beat expert judgement (Clinical versus statistical prediction)	Choices	Solid	Meehl 1954; 136 studies (Grove et al. 2000); Kleinberg et al. 2018
155	Moral licensing	Self	Debated	Monin & Miller 2001; near zero to small once bias is corrected (Kuper & Bott 2019)
157	People say yes more than you think	Influence	Good	Flynn & Lake 2008; Bohns et al. 2014; review by Bohns 2016
158	Most worries never happen	Feelings	Good	91% of worries didn't happen (LaFreniere & Newman 2020)
159	The halo effect	Connection	Solid	Thorndike 1920; Nisbett & Wilson 1977; Todorov et al. 2005
160	Denominator neglect (The ratio bias)	Choices	Solid	Denes-Raj & Epstein 1994; Yamagishi 1997
165	The law of small numbers	Thinking	Solid	Tversky & Kahneman 1971; Wainer & Zwerling 2006
166	Forced teaming and other warning signs (Pre-incident indicators)	Influence	Debated	Burger et al. 2004 (62% vs 34%); the rest is casework
167	Money and happiness, revised	Feelings	Good	Kahneman & Deaton 2010, revised by Killingsworth, Kahneman & Mellers 2023
168	The myth of spotting liars (Reading lies from body language)	Connection	Busted	54% accuracy across 206 studies (Bond & DePaulo 2006)
169	The certainty and possibility effects (The fourfold pattern)	Choices	Solid	Kahneman & Tversky 1979; 19-country replication (Ruggeri et al. 2020)
170	The premortem	Habits	Good	Mitchell et al. 1989; Veinott et al. 2010; Klein 2007
171	The panic myth (Normalcy bias)	Groups	Good	NIST World Trade Center interviews; Drury et al. 2009

DAY	CONCEPT	AREA	EVIDENCE	KEY STUDIES
174	The affect heuristic	Thinking	Good	Finucane et al. 2000; Johnson et al. 1993
177	Charm that fades (The narcissist's first impression)	Connection	Good	Paulhus 1998; Back et al. 2010
178	Narrow framing (Myopic loss aversion)	Choices	Good	Gneezy & Potters 1997; Benartzi & Thaler 1999; Larson et al. 2016
179	Round numbers as goals	Habits	Solid	Pope & Simonsohn 2011; 9.8 million marathon times (Allen et al. 2017)
180	Hidden profiles (The shared-information bias)	Groups	Solid	Stasser & Titus 1985; meta-analysis of 65 studies (Lu et al. 2012)
183	Outcome bias	Thinking	Solid	Baron & Hershey 1988; NBA line-ups (Lefgren et al. 2015)
185	The Romeo and Juliet effect myth	Connection	Busted	Registered replication found the opposite (Sinclair et al. 2014)
186	Less is better	Choices	Good	Hsee 1998; List 2002; close replication (Vonasch et al. 2023)
188	Broken windows (The spreading of disorder)	Groups	Debated	Keizer et al. 2008, but Braga et al. 2015; O'Brien et al. 2019
190	When to trust your gut	Thinking	Good	Kahneman & Klein 2009; Klein et al. 1986; Barber & Odean 2000
192	Opportunity cost neglect	Choices	Good	Frederick et al. 2009; meta-analysis of 39 experiments (Maguire et al. 2023)
193	Basking in reflected glory	Groups	Good	Cialdini et al. 1976; Boen et al. 2002
194	Consider the opposite	Thinking	Good	Lord et al. 1984; Mussweiler et al. 2000; Mamede et al. 2010

From Quiet and The Man Who Mistook His Wife for a Hat (15)

DAY	CONCEPT	AREA	EVIDENCE	KEY STUDIES
145	The multitasking myth (Task switching)	Perception	Solid	Rubinstein et al. 2001; phone calls doubled missed red lights (Strayer & Johnston 2001)
154	Left-brained and right-brained people	Perception	Busted	1,011 brain scans (Nielsen et al. 2013); 91% of UK teachers believed it (Dekker et al. 2012)
163	Face blindness (Prosopagnosia)	Perception	Good	2.5% of 689 students (Kennerknecht et al. 2006); passport officers (White et al. 2014)
164	Acting extraverted (Acting out of character)	Self	Good	Zelenski et al. 2013; week-long trial (Jacques-Hamilton et al. 2019)
172	The weak human nose myth	Perception	Busted	Scent-tracking in a field (Porter et al. 2007); McGann 2017
173	The personality type myth (Personality types)	Self	Busted	Retest changes (Pittenger 2005); scores bunch in the middle (Bess & Harvey 2002)

DAY	CONCEPT	AREA	EVIDENCE	KEY STUDIES
176	**The venting myth** (Catharsis)	Feelings	Busted	Bushman 2002; 154 studies (Kjærvik & Bushman 2024)
181	**The video-camera memory myth** (Permanent memory)	Perception	Busted	Loftus & Loftus 1980; hypnosis adds confident errors (Dywan & Bowers 1983)
184	**The five stages of grief**	Feelings	Busted	Resilience most common (Bonanno et al. 2002); Maciejewski et al. 2007
187	**The 10,000-hour rule**	Habits	Busted	Ericsson et al. 1993; Macnamara et al. 2014; replication (Macnamara & Maitra 2019)
191	**Feelings outlast memories**	Connection	Good	Feinstein et al. 2010; Guzmán-Vélez et al. 2014; Johnson et al. 1985
197	**The babble effect** (The babble hypothesis)	Groups	Good	Anderson & Kilduff 2009; speaking time and leadership (MacLaren et al. 2020)
198	**The single-gene myth** (Candidate genes)	Thinking	Busted	Caspi et al. 2003, unsupported in 38,802 people (Culverhouse et al. 2018); Border et al. 2019
200	**Social facilitation** (The audience effect)	Groups	Good	Pool players (Michaels et al. 1982); 241 studies (Bond & Titus 1983)
202	**Open-plan offices**	Groups	Good	Bernstein & Turban 2018; Pejtersen et al. 2011; Kim & de Dear 2013

From Telling Lies, Spy the Lie and Mindhunter (9)

DAY	CONCEPT	AREA	EVIDENCE	KEY STUDIES
175	**False confessions**	Influence	Solid	Kassin & Kiechel 1996; Russano et al. 2005; Meissner et al. 2014
182	**The innocence trap**	Self	Good	Kassin & Norwick 2004; the Central Park jogger case
189	**The microexpression myth** (Lie to Me)	Perception	Busted	Porter & ten Brinke 2008; Jordan et al. 2019; Lie to Me viewers (Levine et al. 2010)
195	**The truth default**	Connection	Good	Levine 2014; Park et al. 2002; SEC Inspector General on Madoff (2009)
196	**The lie detector test** (The polygraph)	Choices	Debated	National Research Council 2003; the Aldrich Ames case
199	**The presumption of guilt** (The Othello error)	Connection	Good	Kassin, Goldstein & Savitsky 2003; PEACE interviewing; Meissner et al. 2014
201	**A few prolific liars**	Thinking	Good	Serota, Levine & Boster 2010; 91-day diary study (Serota et al. 2021)
203	**Criminal profiling** (Mindhunting)	Thinking	Debated	Snook et al. 2007; Canter et al. 2004; Alison et al. 2003; the Colin Stagg case
204	**The emotional victim effect**	Groups	Good	Kaufmann et al. 2003; Bollingmo et al. 2008; the Chamberlain case

STRESS TEST

Every account, and everything else

You asked for a stress test on all accounts. The riskiest thing Mindfield does with an account is back up your journal to Google Drive, so the test centred on linking, unlinking and switching Google accounts on one or more phones while notes are written, edited and deleted. The rest of the app got the full suite too.

SCENARIO	HOW IT WAS TESTED	RESULT
Switch from one Google account to another	Unlink, then Connect: unit test plus a screen test of Unlink	Pass after fix 1: the chooser appears, notes merge, the old backup is left as it was
Unlink while a backup is uploading	Unit test, plus 5,502 interrupted jobs in the simulation	Pass after fix 2: nothing reaches the account you removed
Three phones, two accounts, random use	300 runs × 250 random steps (75,000 steps): 5,241 uploads, 1,487 account switches, notes written, edited and deleted throughout	Pass: no note lost, nothing uploaded to an unlinked account, every phone ends identical to the backup
Unlink with no internet	Unit test plus screen test	Pass after fix 5: unlinks on the phone and says what to do next
Google won't reveal the account's address	Unit test	Pass after fix 3: backups continue; the card says "your Google account"
Link and unlink racing across threads	8 threads × 20,000 operations	Pass
Existing users updating to the bigger library, twice	151 → 180 → 195 concepts; 17 user histories from 1 to 400 days of use on each earlier library	Pass: past days, today's concept and review cards never change, and everyone meets every new concept
The 204-concept library	Format, lengths, answers, quotes, area rotation, evidence labels	Pass
Reminders, notifications, alarms and the widget	22 Robolectric tests	Pass
Screens, large text and dark mode	18 screen tests with screenshots	Pass
Do the tests catch a real bug?	Mutation test: switched off the guard's unlink	4 tests failed, as they should
Do the upgrade tests catch a bad insert?	Mutation test: moved one new card to the front of its area	2 tests failed, as they should
Google Play rules	Manifest and build check	Pass: targets Android 16 (API 36); no USE_EXACT_ALARM; no battery-exemption prompt

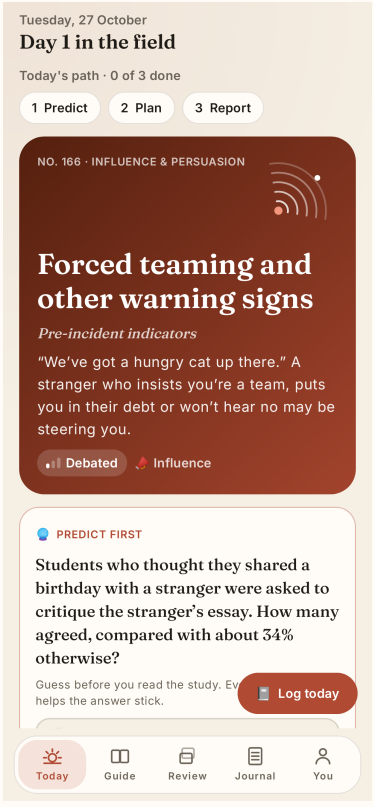
The simulation drives the real merge, backup format and link guard: each step a random phone writes, edits or deletes a note, connects to one of two accounts, queues a backup, unlinks (with Google unreachable one time in five), or advances a sync that is already running. After every step it checks that no note has vanished and that nothing went to an account other than the one chosen since the last unlink.

STRESS TEST

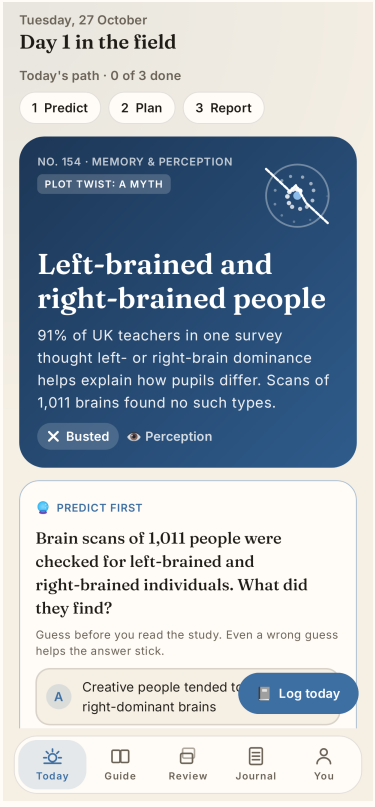
Bugs found and fixed

#	PROBLEM	FIX
1	Switching Google accounts was impossible. After Unlink, Google still held the app's permission, so Connect silently handed back the same account.	Unlink now revokes the permission with Google (Identity API revokeAccess, Play services auth 21.5.0), so Connect shows the account chooser.
2	A sync already running when you tapped Unlink could still upload your journal to the account you had just removed, or quietly link it again.	Each sync carries a ticket. Unlink voids every ticket and cancels a scheduled upload, and running work checks its ticket before merging, uploading or linking.
3	If Google didn't return the account's address, backups could silently stay off.	The app falls back to "your Google account" and keeps backing up.
4	Switching accounts gave no explanation of where backups now go.	"Now backing up to [new], and brought in N field notes already saved there. The backup in [old] stays as it was."
5	Unlinking offline gave no sign that Google hadn't been told.	A message explains it and says to tap Unlink again once online if Connect picks the same account.
6	The About screen promised "about five months" of discovery, hard-coded.	Now computed from the library size: about six months.

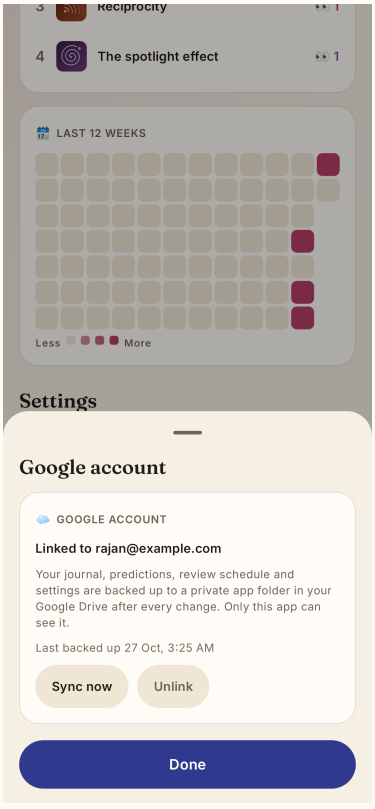
From the build's screen tests



From the first five books: day 166, labelled Debated



From Sacks: day 154, taught as a myth



The Google account sheet, with Sync now and Unlink

ROAST

What the roast of my own work caught

Everything I wrote was checked again as if someone else had written it. These are the problems that check found; all were fixed before release.

WHAT I CHECKED	WHAT I FOUND AND FIXED
Duplicates against the 151 existing cards	Dropped two planned cards (dread risk, unity) that repeated existing ones, and used a different study for outcome bias because the planned one was already in Hindsight bias.
Every number and name against its source	Fixed the dinnerware price ($33, not $32), a 69% election figure wrongly tied to one-second glimpses, a researcher's first name (Francis Larson), the start date of the camera-angle research, Tversky and Kahneman's "9 of 84", and an unverifiable "preregistered".
The quality of the sources themselves	Replaced a case built on a researcher who resigned over data problems with a JAMA study of doctors, and relabelled the existing "But you are free" card from Good to Debated.
Citations	Added eight sources the cards already described but didn't cite, including Benartzi and Thaler 1999.
Quiz fairness	Rewrote five scenarios that gave the answer away or were ambiguous.
Wording about real people	Removed guessed pronouns for real people; fictional characters keep theirs.
The tests themselves	Found and fixed a test bug that made the account-switch counter always read zero; the mutation test showed the tests fail when the guard is broken.
Quiet and Sacks: every number against its source	Fixed before release: a hook that implied a gene was tested in 443,000 people when that sample size applied to other genes; an overall practice figure that sources give as 12% or 14%, replaced by the confirmed per-field figures; "explains" softened to "helps explain" for a teachers' survey; a claim that the grief stages were never tested (they later were); a passport-officer task described wrongly; and a researcher's first name that couldn't be confirmed, now left out.
Quiet and Sacks: claims stronger than the evidence	"The people who multitask most are worse at it" now says "in one study"; the dementia card says a warm visit "may" lift mood, since the studies used film clips; and the grief card no longer says the researchers saw "partial support" when they argued for the stages.
Quiet and Sacks: the source itself	Sacks's case histories are treated as stories, not evidence, after The New Yorker's 2025 report on Sacks's journals. Every Sacks card rests on independent studies.
Quiet and Sacks: wording and tests	Removed pronouns I had guessed for three researchers. Moving one new card to the front of its area failed 2 of the 6 upgrade tests, so they do catch a change to days people have already had.
The three crime books: every number against its source	Kept only figures confirmed by an abstract or an independent summary. Left out, or stated without numbers: the confession rates by condition in the minimisation study, the waiver rates in the innocence study, the breakdown of how lies were discovered, and a participant count for the Lie to Me study that sources gave inconsistently (now "about a hundred").

WHAT I CHECKED	WHAT I FOUND AND FIXED
The three crime books: claims stronger than the evidence	The Central Park case says the teenagers gave “videotaped statements admitting involvement” and reports what the men have said since, rather than what they believed. The Chamberlain case says forensic evidence, not demeanour alone, drove the conviction. Profiling is Debated, not Busted, because a second analysis was more favourable to profilers.
The three crime books: fairness to the authors	Spy the Lie gets credit for rejecting eye contact, microexpressions and baselining, which the research supports; its model is described as untested rather than wrong.

Limits and open risks

Not yet tried on a real phone with two accounts.	Unlink followed by Connect showing the chooser follows Google’s documented behaviour and is covered by unit and screen tests, but this cloud session has no phone. A two-minute check: You → Google account → Unlink → Connect → pick the other account.
Unlinking may also sign the Meditation Timer out of Drive.	Both apps share one Google Cloud project, so revoking access for one can ask the other to connect again.
Android tests run only on GitHub.	This environment’s network policy blocks dl.google.com, so the Android SDK can’t be downloaded here. The 86 core tests also ran locally; all 128 pass on GitHub Actions.
Day numbers moved for late concepts.	The first addition moved the 16 concepts that were days 136–151; the second moved the 36 that were days 145–180; the third moved the 21 that were days 175–195, which now fall between days 176 and 202. Nobody has reached day 136 yet (the app started on 2 October 2026), so no one sees a change.
Small studies behind two Sacks cards.	Feelings outlast memories rests on studies of 5 and 17 patients plus an older study of amnesia, and is labelled Good, not Solid, for that reason.
Evidence labels can change.	The 19 Debated concepts should be revisited as new replications appear.
Some papers couldn’t be opened from here.	Where a paper was unreachable, its figures were checked against at least one independent summary or the book’s own account, and cards stay qualitative where a number couldn’t be confirmed.
A cosmetic issue that predates this work.	On the Today screen, the floating “Log today” button can cover the last line of the predict hint until you scroll.

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Sources behind the verdicts in this report. Each new concept's own sources are listed on its card in the app.

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Build 55, from commit d45d2f2 on the **claude/mindfield-app** branch. All 128 tests passed on GitHub Actions before it was published. The link below always serves the newest build.

github.com/rajan199620-cpu/expert-octo-train/releases/download/mindfield-apk/mindfield.apk

Targets Android 16 (API 36) and keeps to Google Play's rules: no USE_EXACT_ALARM permission and no prompt to disable battery optimisation.